Day 59 (stop 2 of 2) - Merle Gunby, Memorial Forest

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Sydenham section · hike 78 · Jones Falls & Memorial Forest, west of Owen Sound

5.2 km / 3.3 mi	~1.7 h	3.9 km new	152 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive from home, Sat 7 am

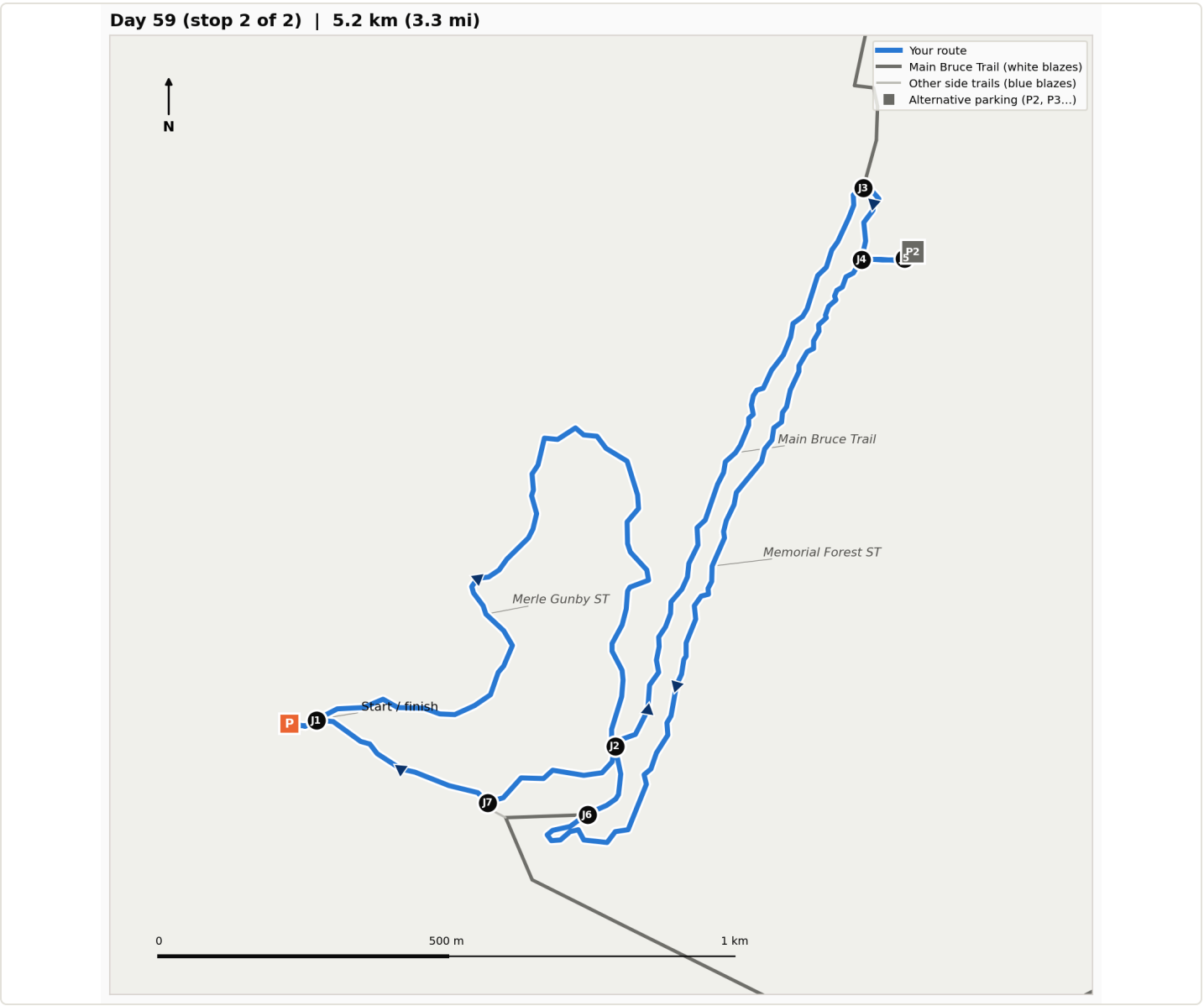
Park (P): Grey-Bruce Tourist Information Office: Enter from Hwy 6, just north of the junction of Hwy 6 and 21. The Merle Gunby Side Trail provides access to the main Trail. Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day59b_hike078.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Merle Gunby Side Trail (2.3 km); Memorial Forest Side Trail (1.6 km)

Same day: this is stop 2 of 2 on day 59 (8.0 mi of hiking, about 310 min total driving). Other stop(s): stop 1: hike 77, 4.7 mi from Harrison Park.

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Park at the Grey-Bruce Tourist Information Office. You enter from Hwy 6, just north of the junction of Hwys 6 and 21. Ontario Nature Trails lists no fee.
- **Merle Gunby Side Trail:** A blue-blazed trail on natural and rocky ground, rated moderate, through hardwood forest. It links the tourist office lot to the main Bruce Trail, and a short spur leads south to Jones Falls.
- **Jones Falls:** Owen Sound Tourism says the Pottawatomi River drops about 12 m over the Escarpment here and recommends the bridge for the best view. From the top you can stand at the lip of the falls and look straight down, so keep Zappy well back from the edge.

Trilliums line the trail in spring.

- **Memorial Forest Side Trail:** The Sydenham club suggests taking this side trail down to the base of Jones Falls for a close-up view. Expect a descent, then a climb back up to the main trail.
- **Dogs:** Zappy stays on leash. The Sydenham club asks that dogs be leashed and kept under control, especially near farmland, and suggests an orange or fluorescent harness or bandana in hunting season so a dog isn't mistaken for wildlife.

Parking options

	Alternative parking	Parking cost	Route km	Walk to trail	Closest side trails
P2	Roadside parking at the end of Young's Dr map	Free	3.0	0 m	Memorial Forest

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Grey-Bruce Tourist Information Office: Enter from Hwy 6, just north of the junction of.... Walk about 30 m to the trail. Head north-east on the blue-blazed Merle Gunby Side Trail.
0.0	0.0	J1: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Merle Gunby Side Trail, heading north-east. (the blue-blazed Merle Gunby Side Trail goes off on your right.)
1.6	1.0	J2: Turn sharp left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-east. (the blue-blazed Merle Gunby Side Trail goes off ahead; the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
2.8	1.7	J3: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Memorial Forest Side Trail, heading south-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
2.9	1.8	J4: Junction. Turn left to stay on the Memorial Forest Side Trail, heading east. (the blue-blazed Memorial Forest Side Trail goes off ahead.)
3.0	1.9	J5: End of the Memorial Forest Side Trail. There is trailhead parking here (Roadside parking at the end of Young's Dr). Turn around and retrace your steps.
3.1	1.9	J4: Junction. Turn left to stay on the Memorial Forest Side Trail, heading south-west. (the Memorial Forest Side Trail you already walked goes off on your right.)
4.4	2.8	J6: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
4.6	2.8	J2: Turn sharp left onto the blue-blazed Merle Gunby Side Trail, heading south-west. (the main Bruce Trail you already walked goes off on your right; the Merle Gunby Side Trail you already walked goes off ahead.)
4.9	3.0	J7: Junction. Turn right to stay on the Merle Gunby Side Trail, heading north-west. (the blue-blazed Merle Gunby Side Trail goes off on your left.)
5.2	3.2	J1: Junction. Turn left to stay on the Merle Gunby Side Trail, heading west. (the Merle Gunby Side Trail you already walked goes off on your right.)
5.2	3.3	Leave the trail and walk back to the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Ontario Nature Trails, Owen Sound Tourism and the Sydenham Bruce Trail Club.